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‘They’re using a hammer when they should be using a scalpel.’

TERRI CANNON, *higher education consultant, on the Trump administration’s challenge to the university accreditation system*

Universities face fight over accreditation

Loss of standing would deliver a crippling financial blow

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

Amid its ongoing battle with Harvard University, the White House is zeroing in on an overlooked, but enormously influential, corner of the higher education system: accreditation.

The Trump administration on

Wednesday called on the New England Commission of Higher Education — an independent nonprofit that oversees around 230 colleges and universities — to revoke Harvard’s accreditation, claiming the school has allowed antisemitism to flourish on campus and violated anti-discrimination laws. Loss of ac-

creditation would stop the flow of federal financial aid to Harvard, a significant blow to a school of its standing.

It speaks to how far the White House is willing to go to bend universities to their will, some higher education experts said.

The New England commission

and other accreditors are independent nonprofits that do not answer directly to the federal government, though they are reviewed by the Department of Education.

Education Secretary Linda McMahon said in the notice Wednesday the Trump administration will closely follow the commission’s response to the Harvard mandate.

ACCREDITATION, Page A15

INSIDE THE WAR ON HARVARD

From Harvard to the Heartland, a lifeline, now threatened



KATE MUNSCH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Stephen and Jean Sehy with one of their grandchildren in Teutopolis, Ill. At his diagnosis, they were told to prepare for hospice.

A scientist’s work helped save his life. Such research is now under siege.

By Kay Lazar
GLOBE STAFF

Stephen Sehy was dying. He just didn’t know it yet.

In the spring of 2009, when he was 63, ominous-looking black bumps began appearing in front of his right ear. Doctors went to remove them, only to discover melanoma, an aggressive skin cancer. It was stage 4 — it had already spread to his spine and liver.

“You’ll want to call hospice,” the surgeon told Sehy’s wife, Jean, before her husband even woke from anesthesia.

At the time, about 70,000



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

At Harvard Medical School, Dr. Arlene Sharpe and her husband, Dr. Gordon Freeman, did pioneering work that was critical in developing cancer treatments.

Americans were diagnosed with melanoma every year. When the disease tipped into the advanced stages, it was pretty much a death sentence — only about 5 percent of patients might go into remission. Sehy’s doctors estimated he had six months to live, though chemotherapy might stretch that a little longer if he could tolerate the side effects.

Jean was quiet and numb on the drive back to rural Illinois, mulling over the prognosis. They’d been married 40 years and raised four children. Sehy owned a marketing supply com-

TREATMENT, Page A14

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — It was the morning of the annual back-to-school prep event at Our Lady of Perpetual Help Catholic School in Selma, Texas, and Toni Lee Jimenez was nervous.

►President Trump announced a 30 percent tariff on goods from the EU and Mexico. **A12.**

She’s not a new student or even the parent of one. Jimenez is a small business owner caught on President Trump’s tariff roller coaster. And the first test of its impact was last month, at her table in the cafeteria of the San Antonio-area school.

Jimenez sells knee socks adorned with bows — made in China largely because of those embellishments — and contributes 5 percent of the proceeds to scholarships. The Wildcat Round-up on June 25 was her first event since she hiked the price of a two-pack of Scholar Sox by \$1, to \$15.99 after the

TARIFFS, Page A13

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\$6.00



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Just growing

Sunday: Clouds early.
High: 76-81. Low: 66-71.
Monday: Humid, stormy.
Complete report, **A22.**
Deaths, **A16-21.**

In 1985, the performers at Live Aid offered a musical feast to fight famine. Our reporter looks back 40 years. **N1.**

The increasing number of white sharks off Cape Cod is called a success story decades in the making. **B1.**

We offer the ultimate guide to Boston-area food and fun in the Best of the Best issue of the **Globe Magazine.**

The Red Sox won their 9th straight, beating the Rays, 1-0, behind Garrett Crochet’s shut-out. **C1.**



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